Participant Information Sheet

[Study title]
[Organisation / school / department]

Version [1.0] · **Date** [dd Month yyyy] · **Ethics reference** [number]

Kia ora,

You are invited to take part in a research study about [topic]. Please read this information sheet carefully before you decide whether to take part. Taking part is entirely voluntary. If you decide not to take part, there will be no disadvantage to you of any kind.

What is the purpose of this study?

This study aims to understand [research aim, in plain language]. The findings will be used for [e.g. a Master's thesis, a journal article, improving a service].

Who is running the study?

[Researcher name], [role, e.g. postgraduate student], [organisation].
Supervised by [supervisor name and title].

Why have I been invited?

You have been invited because [who is eligible, e.g. you are an international student currently enrolled at …]. We are inviting up to 50 people to take part.

What will I be asked to do?

The study is completed online and takes about [30] minutes. You will:

- Read this information sheet and confirm you have read it.
- Give your consent by ticking five statements.
- Look at 36 photos and arrange them on a grid, from the ones you most disagree with to the ones you most agree with. This is called a Q-sort.
- Complete a second Q-sort with the same kind of photos, responding to a different question.
- Receive a confirmation email when you have finished.

You can stop at any time and come back later using your participant code. Your progress is saved after each step.

Are there any risks or benefits?

We do not expect any risks beyond those of everyday life. [Describe any possible discomfort, e.g. some photos may relate to personal experiences, and how this is managed.]

There is no direct benefit to you, but your responses will help [expected benefit]. [If applicable: as a thank you, you will receive …].

What data will be collected, and how will it be used?

- Your responses are linked to a participant code, not your name.

- Your email address is stored separately and used only to send your confirmation email [and, if you ask, a summary of the findings].
- We record the date and time you complete each step and how long each sort takes.
- Results will be reported as group patterns. You will not be identifiable in any report or publication.

How will my data be stored and protected?

Data is stored in a secure, password-protected account that only the research team can access. [Name the storage location if your ethics committee requires it, e.g. university-managed Google Workspace or Microsoft 365.] Data will be kept for [number] years after the study ends and then securely deleted, in line with [organisation's data retention policy].

Can I change my mind and withdraw?

Yes. You can stop taking part at any time without giving a reason. You can also ask for your data to be withdrawn up until [date, e.g. 31 March 2027], after which the analysis will have begun. To withdraw, email the researcher with your participant code.

Will I find out the results?

If you would like a summary of the findings, let the researcher know by email. The summary will be sent around [month and year].

Who can I contact with questions?

Researcher	[Name] [email] [phone, optional]
Supervisor	[Name] [email]

Ethics approval

This study has been reviewed and approved by [ethics committee name], reference [number]. If you have any concerns about the ethical conduct of this research, you may contact the committee at [email]. Any concerns will be treated in confidence and investigated, and you will be told of the outcome.

Thank you for considering taking part. Ngā mihi nui.